



Pressed, Not Wired

Auditing the Learning Commons Crossing Button Against a Term of Logged Signal-Phase Changes

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Motivation

Traffic-committee cases lean on demand evidence a pedestrian can generate with a thumb. What does a press count actually track?

Aims

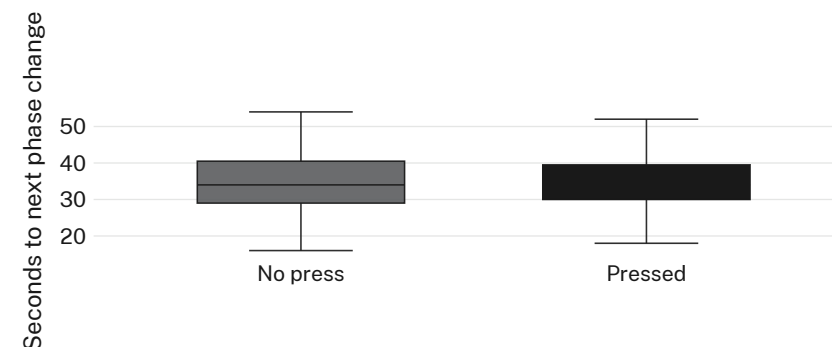
- Press precedes a measurable phase change?
- Presses vs. the controller's own phase log
- Demand figure tracks volume –or something else?

Study design

- 14-week log (30 Mar –6 Jul 2026); independent recorder, controller housing
- $n = 6,214$ presses matched to logged transitions, ± 90 s window; kerb counter holds volume constant
- Matching window pre-registered; no post-hoc adjustment

Findings

5.8% of presses precede a phase change inside the window – the intersection's own cycle, not the press. Weekly press volume vs. phase-change count: $r = 0.06$.



Median time to the next phase change held at 34 seconds whether or not the button was pressed, unchanged across all 14 logged weeks (30 Mar –6 Jul 2026).

What it means

A felt sense of agency, not a controller input. The Committee's case for a second crossing still cites the same tally as its lead demand figure. Next: audit the disclosure.

Selected references

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“Nobody has ever pressed this button and changed anything.”

6,214 presses logged over 14 weeks; the signal held its own timer throughout.